intervention could provide information on affairs such as the Red Terror and the civil war, yet could comment little on Bolshevik foreign policy.[87] Even some of the trips to Russia made by British representatives later on in the 1920s still focused their attention on domestic affairs.[88] The proclamations made by Lenin and his men upon seizing power and during the Brest-Litovsk negotiations were about the only official statements on Soviet foreign policy which British officials could study.[89] From these limited resources, Whitehall certainly realised the anti-imperialist nature of the Bolshevik government. The events of Brest-Litovsk also taught them not to trust the new regime in Moscow. However, little was understood of the practicalities of Soviet foreign policy or about specific Bolshevik intentions towards Asia.[90] With such little knowledge on which to judge Bolshevik foreign policy (particularly in the early years after 1917), many British officials would simply fall back on what they knew – the Great Game. As long as the Great Game mentality existed in the minds of key British officials then the Great Game continued on. To some, while Russian domestic politics were continually turbulent, the one constant had always been that country's ambition in Asia. Thus, in the early years after the October revolution, there were many in London who simply used the same framework they had always used – their mental maps – and formulated policy based on Russia's potential to threaten the stability of southern Asia.

Adding further complexity to the issue of British opinion on Russia after 1917 is the distinction between the Home government in London and the Indian government in Delhi. For as will be seen, Delhi appeared far less concerned with Russia and with Bolshevism than London, and far more interested in the issues of Asian nationalism and pan-Islamism. This appears in part due to the intelligence reports which the Indian government was receiving from its agencies about the progress (or lack thereof) of Russian intrigue within Asia and India itself.[91]

The debates between Delhi and London will be a central feature of the following chapters. What is important to emphasise here is that not enough scholars have taken the time to try to comprehensively explain these issues surrounding the thought processes of those involved in British foreign affairs after the First World War. As can be seen, trying to understand what influenced British government officials and what motivated their advocacy